SAILENT FEATURES OF THE RESERVE BANK OF INDIA – INTEGRATED OMBUDSMAN SCHEME 2026

The Reserve Bank of India – Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2026 (RBI IOS 2026) aims to provide a cost-effective, expeditious, non-adversarial alternate grievance redress mechanism for the resolution of complaints against Regulated Entities covered under the Scheme.

Grounds for complaint

Any customer aggrieved by an act or omission of a Regulated Entity resulting in deficiency in service may file a complaint under the Scheme personally or through an authorized representative.

Ground for maintainability of a complaint

- Customers must first approach the concerned Regulated Entity before filing a complaint with RBI Ombudsman.
- Complaint can be filed if no response is received within 30 days (or prescribed timeline) from the Regulated Entity, and should be filed within 90 days thereafter.
- Complaint should be addressed directly to RBI Ombudsman and mere marking of RBI is not valid.
- The Complaint should be filed by the complainant or an authorized representative other than an advocate unless the advocate is the aggrieved person.
- Complaint should contain the complete information as specified in the Scheme.
- Must not be frivolous, vexatious, or abusive in nature.
- Complaint should not be pending before or already decided by the RBI Ombudsman.
- Complaint should not be pending before or decided by any court, tribunal, arbitrator, or any other judicial or quasi-judicial forum
- Original complaint to Regulated Entity must be within the limitation period under the Limitation Act, 1963.

Procedure for filing a complaint:

- Complaint under the scheme may be lodged online through the portal https://cms.rbi.org.in
- The complaint may also be submitted through e-mail or physical mode to the Centralised Receipt and Processing Centre as notified by the Reserve Bank.
- All such complaints are processed through the Centralised Receipt and Processing Centre (CRPC):
    - Email: crpc@rbi.org.in
    - Address: Centralised Receipt and Processing Centre, 4th Floor, Reserve Bank of India, Sector 17, Central Vista, Chandigarh – 160017

The complaints involving the following matters are excluded from the purview of the Scheme:

a) matters related to commercial judgment or decision of a Regulated Entity;
b) a dispute between a vendor and a Regulated Entity;
c) grievances against Management or Executives of a Regulated Entity;
d) a grievance arising from an action of a Regulated Entity in compliance with the orders of a judicial/quasi-judicial or statutory or law enforcing authority;
e) a service not within the regulatory purview of the Reserve Bank;
f) a dispute between Regulated Entities;
g) a dispute involving the employee-employer relationship of a Regulated Entity;

h) a grievance for which a remedy has been provided in Section 18 of the Credit Information Companies (Regulation) Act, 2005; and
i) a grievance pertaining to customers of Regulated Entity not included under the Scheme.

Complaints not meeting the eligibility conditions as specified under the Scheme and complaints that are mentioned in sub-clause (2) of the Scheme, shall be rejected at the outset as non-maintainable without further examination, with appropriate communication to the Complainant.

Appeal Mechanism

- Both the complainant and the Regulated Entity have the right to file an appeal before the appellate authority within 30 days from the receipt of the Ombudsman's decision.
- Appeals are to be made before the Appellate Authority (Executive Director, Reserve Bank of India).
- Appellate Authority may dismiss, modify, set aside, or remand the case
- Decision of Appellate Authority is final and binding, with effect similar to Ombudsman's order

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